SPORTING SPIRIT

Jemimah Rodrigues is one of the cricketers to watch in the ongoing season of the Women's Premier League



Q. How has women's cricket evolved since the Women's Premier League launched in 2023?

I come from a generation where nobody paid attention to women's cricket. In fact, when I started out, I didn't even know there was a women's team. I have played in stadiums with just 10-15 spectators, most of them family members, and to entire stadiums being packed and audiences chanting our names. So we have come a long way.

Q. Your team, Delhi Capitals, has been runner-up twice. Third time lucky?

That's the plan. It still hurts to lose in two consecutive finals. But we have played tremendous cricket throughout in both seasons, and to consistently be in the finals is an achievement. It's just about things falling in place on that given day.

Q. And in terms of player development?

As a youngster who hasn't had international experience, you are seeing the likes of Harmanpreet Kaur and Sophie Devine, and their professionalism. You know what the benchmark is and how much effort is needed. Personally, being part of overseas leagues has helped. Knowing that a franchise has picked you gives you a lot of confidence as does doing well against quality players and in different conditions.

Q. Recently, your celebration of posing with the bat as a guitar, after scoring a century against Ireland, went viral. Does music play an instrumental part?

In fact, I do that pose at every photo shoot. I told myself that the day I score a hundred, I will do it. It took some time but I was happy to be able to do it. Music helps me switch off and unwind, especially strumming the guitar. And my guitar travels with me on tour.

—with Suhani Singh

GETTY IMAGES